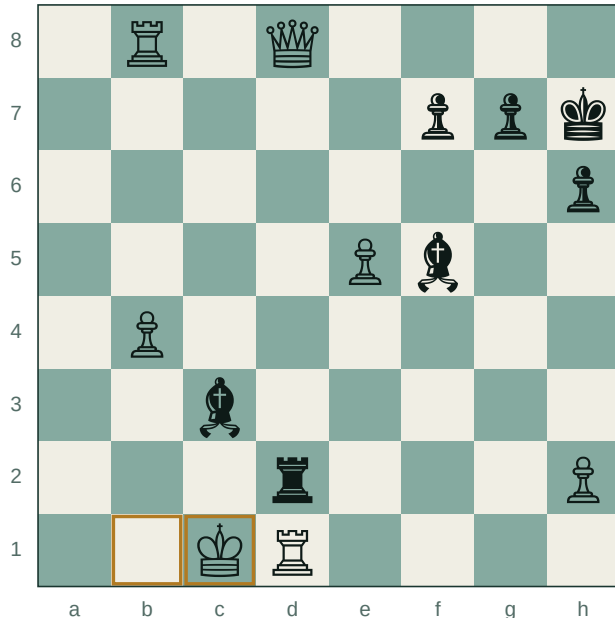


Double checks: Black, move 36

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Kc1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36...Rc2+ 37. Kb1 Rb2+ 38. Ka1 Rxb2#

36...Rc2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37.Kb1**.

37...Rb2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on f5 attacks the king on b1. Recorded reply: **38.Ka1**.

38...Rxb2# Mate: bishop on c3 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Bishop on c3. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on c1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.